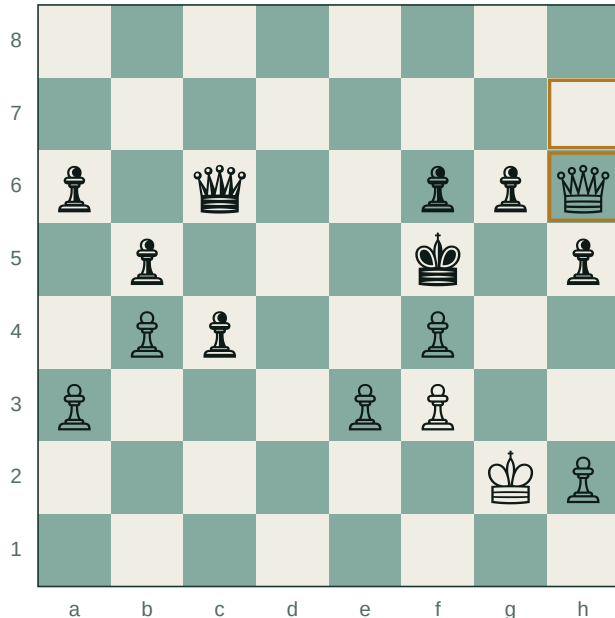


Queen-ending tactics: Black, move 36

Queen-ending tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 36.Qh6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

36...c3 37. e4+ Ke6 38. f5+ gxf5

36...c3 The pawn moves from c4 to c3. Recorded reply: **37.e4+**.

37...Ke6 The king moves from f5 to e6. Recorded reply: **38.f5+**.

38...gxf5 The pawn captures the pawn on f5.

At the end, nominal material is White 14 / Black 15 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +1**: the balance goes from +0 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A favorable-looking queen exchange can lead to a drawn pawn ending. Evaluate the new ending before simplifying.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Queens combine long-range checks with promotion support. King shelter and the order of checks often matter more than a small material lead.

HOW TO LOOK

Inspect perpetual-check possibilities, queen trades, and checks that gain a tempo for a passed pawn.

The defending king is on g2. Absolute pin: pawn on f3.